



WASHINGTON, DC CIVIC JOURNEY · 8TH GRADE · APRIL 14 TO 18, 2027

Chaperone Briefing

For the five staff who travel with Emily Carter. Read it before the briefing on Friday, April 9, carry it with the Trip Leader Card, and keep the pocket emergency card on you all week.

Your group and your role

Student names and individual needs are on the controlled roster you receive on April 9

GROUP	CHAPERONE	ROLE ON THE TRIP	ALSO
A	Emily Carter	Trip leader: decisions, venue check-ins, calls to school, closes every head count	Watch to midnight
B	Marcus Lee	Co-leader: rear head count, regrouping, holds the other groups in any incident	Corridors to 11:00 p.m.; watch to 3:00 a.m.
C	Rachel Morgan, RN	School nurse: medications, health records, first aid, medication station at the hotel	Watch 3:00 a.m. to arrival
D	Olivia Bennett	Learning lead: field journals, site prompts, the closing seminar	Watch to 3:00 a.m.
E	Daniel Kim	Logistics: bus, luggage, meals, passes, driver liaison, hotel keys and damage	Corridors to 11:00 p.m.; watch 3:00 a.m. to arrival
F	Aisha Thompson	Student support: access needs, participation, rooming welfare, any student in distress	Watch to midnight

Every chaperone has the same first job: your five students, all week. You count them, you know where they are, and you are the adult they tell first. Students travel in buddy pairs inside your group and tell you before they use a restroom.

The head count

- Count before boarding, after boarding, when leaving the bus, inside every venue entrance, before every move, before and after meals, at every rest stop, and on return to the hotel. Report to Emily by group letter: "B, five." Marcus confirms 30. Nobody moves, and the bus does not move, until Emily closes the count.
- Each morning Emily names the day's regroup point for every site; if the group is split, take your five there and wait. In the African American History and Culture galleries the group goes in as three groups of ten, A with B, C with D, E with F, and the two chaperones stay together.

Daily rhythm

Times are targets; the full day plans are on the Trip Leader Card

Wed, Apr 14	Students report 4:30 a.m.; bus 5:00. Rest stops 6:40, 9:05, 11:35 (lunch). Hotel 1:35 p.m.; rooms 3:00; seminar 4:30; dinner 5:30; room check 8:45; lights-out 9:30.
Thu, Apr 15	Breakfast 6:30; board 7:15. Archives 8:45; Capitol screening 12:30; Library of Congress 2:30; Supreme Court 3:45; board 4:30; dinner 5:15; hotel 6:45; room check 8:45; lights-out 9:30.
Fri, Apr 16	Breakfast 7:00; board 8:15. African American History and Culture 10:00; lunch 12:45; American History 2:00; board 4:15; dinner 5:00; memorial walk 6:30; bus 8:45 sharp; hotel 9:30; lights-out 10:00.
Sat, Apr 17	Breakfast 6:30; rooms cleared; luggage 7:15; board 7:30. Arlington 8:30; board 11:15; lunch 11:45; Portrait Gallery 1:00; Lafayette Square 3:15; hotel 4:30; dinner 4:45; seminar 5:45; drivers 8:15; board 8:45; depart 9:00.
Overnight	Rest stops 10:10 p.m., 12:05, 2:15 and 4:50 a.m. School 5:45 to 6:15 a.m. Sunday; students released only to an adult on the pickup list.



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At the Hotel, on the Bus, and When Something Goes Wrong

Your duties on the corridors and the bus, then the four procedures every chaperone follows. The full emergency plan is on the Trip Leader Card; the numbers are on your pocket card.

At the hotel

- Check every room before students enter. Students go to assigned rooms only; no room changes for any reason.
- Room check and medication round at 8:45 p.m.; lights-out 9:30 p.m. (Friday: room check on return, lights-out 10:00). Rachel's room is the medication station: rounds at 7:00 a.m. and 8:45 p.m.
- Marcus and Daniel walk both corridors until 11:00 p.m. Emily's phone stays on all night; the front desk has her number and calls if a student appears in the lobby.
- Students stay on their floor after room check, keep doors closed, and do not use the pool, the fitness room or any exterior door. A student found off the corridor comes back with you and Emily is told that night.
- Room damage or a missing key goes to Daniel.

A student is separated

1. Stop your group. Confirm where and when the student was last seen. Call Emily.
2. Emily alerts venue security or staff at the nearest staffed point. Marcus holds the other groups at the regroup point.
3. Students do not search. If the student is not found within ten minutes, Emily calls Jordan Patel, who handles the family.
4. Students carry the trip card with Emily's number and the hotel address, and are told to stay where they are and ask a uniformed staff member for help.

A student is hurt or unwell

1. Breathing difficulty, head injury, allergic reaction, fainting or severe pain: call 911 first, then Rachel. Give the exact address or landmark and what happened.
2. Give first aid within your training. Rachel takes over care when she arrives.
3. Stay with the student, with the health record and any medication. If the student goes to hospital, Rachel or you ride in the ambulance or follow by taxi; Emily keeps the group.
4. Emily calls Jordan; the school calls the family. You do not call a family yourself.
5. Minor illness at the hotel: Rachel assesses and Emily decides on a clinic with Jordan. Lost or missed medication: tell Rachel at once.

On the bus

- Assigned seats by group; seat belts fastened whenever seated; aisle clear. Chaperones sit front, middle and rear. The restroom is used one student at a time.
- At every stop, students leave and return with you as a group. Count off, count on. No student is alone anywhere in a plaza; a student who stays on the bus stays with one chaperone.
- Overnight, two chaperones are awake at all times: Emily and Aisha until midnight, Marcus and Olivia until 3:00 a.m., Daniel and Rachel until arrival. Rachel is woken for any health concern. Quiet bus from 10:00 p.m.

A security instruction or evacuation

1. Follow venue staff immediately. Move your group together; nobody goes back for belongings.
2. Count as soon as the group is stationary and report to Emily.
3. Regroup at the day's regroup point, or at the bus if the site is closed. On the road, the bus is the shelter and the drivers choose the stop.

A behavior or welfare concern

1. Correct quietly and move the student to the back of your group. A repeated lapse means the student walks beside you for the rest of the visit.
2. Tell Emily before the group moves on. Aisha joins for any student who is distressed, withdrawn or in conflict.
3. Serious or repeated conduct concerns go to Jordan and the family under school policy, as the student agreement says. Anything a student discloses goes to Jordan the same day.
4. Give students quiet time after the African American History and Culture galleries, the memorials and Arlington. The Arlington reflection stays private.



Screening and conduct at the sites

- Small backpacks only. No food, drink, pocketknives or aerosols into the Archives, Capitol, Library of Congress or museums; lunches stay on the bus and are eaten outside.
- Arlington screens every visitor: carry a government-issued photo ID; students under 16 need none. Quiet voices, no food, no running, hats off at the Tomb, and immediate compliance with cemetery staff. Stop your group for every procession.
- Phones are away during programs, ceremonies and head counts. On the memorial walk, keep your group within sight and use your phone's flashlight on the unlit paths.

- Use the staff group text for operations. Jordan Patel sends every family update: Wednesday arrival, each evening, and after the last overnight stop.
- No student names, health details or photos of other people's children in any message, and nothing on social media during the trip.

- This briefing and the Trip Leader Card; your group's page of the roster and health records, in the school folder, never left on the bus or in a room.
- The pocket emergency card, on you at all times, with the day's regroup point written on it. Every working number is on it.
- Your phone, charged, with the staff group text; government-issued photo ID for Arlington; water; a weather layer.
- Rachel carries the medication case and the first-aid kit; you carry nothing medical for a student unless she hands it to you.

Also on the pocket card and the Trip Leader Card

Emily 216-555-0164	Marcus 216-555-0172	Rachel 216-555-0136
Olivia 216-555-0158	Daniel 216-555-0177	Aisha 216-555-0129
Jordan, school 216-555-0142	Lakefront dispatch 216-555-0186	Thomas, bus 216-555-0181
Angela, overnight bus 216-555-0191	Hotel front desk 301-345-6700	GW University Hospital 202-715-4000

Friday, April 9 · your group, your students' needs, the questions you asked

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Pocket Emergency Card

Print this page on card stock, cut on the marks and fold along the dashed line, printed side out, to a 3.5 by 5 inch card. One for every chaperone, one for Jordan Patel at school, and two spares in the trip folder.



WASHINGTON, DC
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EMERGENCY CARD

Call 911

Give the exact address or landmark, the group size and what happened. On the road: the highway, direction and nearest milepost or plaza. Then call Rachel.

Then

1. First aid within your training; Rachel takes over care.
2. Stay with the student, with the health record and any medication.
3. Marcus stops group movement and counts at the regroup point.
4. Emily calls Jordan. The school calls the family. You do not.
5. Hospital: Rachel or you ride along or follow by taxi. Emily keeps the group.

Call

Emily Carter, leader	216-555-0164	Marcus Lee, co-leader	216-555-0172
Rachel Morgan, RN	216-555-0136	Jordan Patel, school	216-555-0142
Lakefront dispatch	216-555-0186	Hotel front desk	301-345-6700

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Emergency departments

In Washington: George Washington University Hospital, 900 23rd Street NW, DC 20037 · **202-715-4000** · 1.6 miles from the Mall museums, about 9 minutes.

Near the hotel: Adventist HealthCare White Oak Medical Center, 11890 Healing Way, Silver Spring, MD 20904 · **240-637-4000** · 4.1 miles, about 12 minutes. Responders may choose another hospital.

Separated student

1. Stop the group. Last seen where and when. Call Emily.
2. Emily alerts venue security; Marcus holds the other groups. Students do not search.
3. Not found in ten minutes: Emily calls Jordan, who handles the family.

Head count

Count your five, report "B, five." Nobody moves until Emily closes the count. If the group is split, go to the day's regroup point and wait.

Places and numbers

Hotel: Holiday Inn, 10000 Baltimore Ave, College Park, MD 20740	Thomas Reed, bus	216-555-0181
Angela Ruiz, overnight bus	Smithsonian	202-633-1000
Capitol Visitor Center	Arlington Welcome Center	877-907-8585

Regroup point for today: _____

The card carries no student information. It is for the adults on the trip and is collected with the roster on Sunday morning.